

TEAM-Aligned Lesson Plan

U.S. History (Grades 9–12) · Franklin High School · Williamson County Schools

Standard: US.04 — Gilded Age Politics and Economics

Schedule: Regular block — 47 minutes · Date: _____ · Teacher: _____

TN Standard (full text): *Analyze the causes and consequences of Gilded Age politics and economics as well as the significance of the rise of political machines, major scandals, civil service reform, and the economic difference between farmers, wage earners, and industrial capitalists, including: Boss Tweed, Thomas Nast, Credit Mobilier, Spoils system and President James A. Garfield's assassination, Pendleton Act, Interstate Commerce Act.*

1 · Standards & Objectives

Learning objective (I-CAN): “I can analyze the causes and consequences of Gilded Age politics and economics, including political machines, major scandals, civil service reform, and economic differences between farmers, wage earners, and industrial capitalists.”

Sub-objectives (sequenced from the standard's criteria):

- Political Machines and Boss Tweed.
- Major Scandals and the Spoils System.
- Civil Service Reform.

Connection to prior learning: Builds on US.03 (Compromise of 1877, Jim Crow & Plessy v. Ferguson) — students carry yesterday's understanding into today's standard.

Tennessee connection: Tennessee politics during the Gilded Age reflected national patterns of corruption and reform. Memphis boss Edward Hull Crump built one of the South's most powerful political machines, dominating Memphis and Shelby County politics from the early 1900s through the 1950s.

2 · Assessment & Evidence of Mastery

Measured in multiple ways (TEAM: 3+ measures with clear criteria):

- **Selected-response + short constructed:** US.04 Formative Assessment (with teacher answer key).
- **Extended writing:** CER organizer — claim, evidence, reasoning on the Gilded Age Politics and Economics.
- **Primary-source analysis:** HIPP organizer on “Pendleton Civil Service Reform Act” (U.S. Congress, January 16, 1883).
- **Exit ticket (EN + ES):** 2-question check for understanding, bilingual.

Success criteria: Student cites at least two specific pieces of evidence and can analyze the causes and consequences of Gilded Age politics and economics, including political machines, major scandals, civil service reform, and economic differences between farmers, wage earners, and industrial capitalists.

3 · Lesson Structure & Pacing (47-minute Regular block)

Min	Segment & what happens	Material
5	Warm-Up / Bell-Ringer — recall Compromise of 1877, Jim Crow & Plessy v. Ferguson (US.03); frame today's question	Word Bank / Do-Now
4	Hook — Tennessee politics during the Gilded Age reflected national patterns of corruption and reform: Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter?	Teacher Deck
12	Direct Instruction — teacher models close reading of the core content; students capture Cornell Notes	Teacher Deck + Cornell Notes
10	Guided Practice — Cornell Notes + a comparison/analysis organizer	Cornell Notes · organizer
11	Primary Source / HIPP — analyze the source; begin CER	Primary-Source Packet · HIPP · CER organizer
5	Exit Ticket & Closure — 2-question check; preview US.05	Exit Ticket (EN/ES)

Total: 47 minutes (segments sum-verified to the block length; auto-adjusts to 43-min Activities or 41-min Late-Start).

4 · Activities & Materials (teacher-selected)

- Cornell Notes (Universal Front) — direct-teaching capture (cue / notes / summary)
- Cornell Support Backs — optional MTSS scaffold; lives in the Teacher Organizer Toolkit, prints duplex behind the Cornell front, copy only as needed
- Comparison / analysis organizer — structure student thinking on the core content
- Primary-Source Packet + HIPP organizer — sourcing & analysis of “Pendleton Civil Service Reform Act”
- CER organizer — evidence-based extended writing
- Formative Assessment + Exit Ticket (EN/ES) — checks for understanding

Word Bank (key vocabulary): Gilded Age · Political Machines · Spoils System · Boss Tweed · Thomas Nast · Pendleton Act

Complex text, student choice (organizer format), primary sources, and student-to-student discussion are built in — satisfying the TEAM Activities & Materials indicators.

5 · Questioning Plan (DOK ladder, text-based, cite evidence)

Level	Example question (US.04)
DOK 1	Define the key term “Gilded Age” and identify when it occurred.
DOK 2	In your own words, summarize the Gilded Age Politics and Economics and explain why it mattered.
DOK 3	Analyze the economic relationship between farmers, railroads, and industrial capitalists during the Gilded Age.
DOK 4	Evaluate the long-term impact of the Gilded Age Politics and Economics — support your claim with evidence from the source(s).

Anchored to the US.04 content and item bank (DOK 1–4). Majority of questions are text-based; students cite evidence. Teacher may swap in additional bank items.

6 · Thinking & Problem-Solving

- **Analytical thinking:** compare and contrast perspectives within the Gilded Age Politics and Economics.
- **Research-based thinking:** evaluate “Pendleton Civil Service Reform Act” and related sources.
- **Problem-solving (drawing conclusions / justifying):** students build and defend a claim in the CER.

7 · Grouping & Feedback [teacher selects]

- **Grouping:** pairs for the CER organizer; whole-class for the primary-source model; individual exit ticket.
- **Feedback checkpoints:** circulate during Guided Practice and Primary-Source segments; use exit-ticket results to adjust tomorrow's opening.

8 · Differentiation (Knowledge of Students)

- **ELL / WIDA:** UDL/WIDA overlay + sentence frames; Spanish exit ticket for entering/emerging levels.
- **IEP / 504:** chunked Cornell Notes (with the support back), extended time, read-aloud (browser TTS), reduced-item formative option.

9 · Environment Reminders (teacher-implemented)

A lesson plan supports — but cannot manufacture — the TEAM Environment domain. Reminders:

- Set high expectations; frame content with dignity and historical accuracy.
- Establish discussion norms before the primary-source analysis.
- Display current student work; keep materials accessible for the pair activity.

10 · Materials & Where to Print

Included in today's print ZIP (US.04 — print-ready PDF + editable DOCX):

Student (print & copy)	Teacher (your copy)
Cornell Notes (Universal Front)	Teacher Lesson Plan (this doc)
Comparison / analysis organizer	Cornell Support Backs — toolkit (copy as needed, MTSS)

Student (print & copy)	Teacher (your copy)
CER organizer	Formative Assessment — Answer Key
HIPP organizer	Primary-Source Teacher Guide
Primary-Source Packet	UDL / WIDA overlay
Formative Assessment	File Map & Print Guide
Exit Ticket — English & Spanish	

Note: students print the Cornell Notes Universal Front. The Cornell Support Backs (Guided/Light scaffolds) live in the Teacher Organizer Toolkit and print duplex on the reverse — copy them only for students who need them (MTSS), and fade as evidence grows.

Slides (download once for the unit):

Unit 1 Teacher Deck — US.04 slides. Download from Teacher Tools → Lecture Decks → Unit 1. (Decks are reused all unit, so they are not bundled in the daily ZIP.)

11 · Reflection & Next Steps

Teacher reflection (complete after teaching):

- Did students meet the I-CAN? Cite the evidence — exit-ticket % correct, CER quality.
- What worked, and what would I change next time?
- Which sub-objective still needs another touch tomorrow?

Extension / enrichment (for students who mastered it):

- Deeper source work: analyze a second primary source with the HIPP organizer.
- Connect forward: how does the Gilded Age Politics and Economics set up US.05 (Inventions & Innovations of Business Leaders & Entrepreneurs)?

If it's not working (reteach / intervention path):

- Below ~70% mastery on the exit ticket / formative → reteach with entry-tier materials (Cornell Notes + the Cornell Support Back + a shorter source) in a small group — MTSS Tier 2.
- **One click — “Remediate US.04”:** assembles a reteach pack (entry-tier worksheet, targeted DOK 1–2 questions, ELL/IEP supports) as a fresh print ZIP.
- **Mid-lesson trouble:** if pacing slips, protect the 5-min Exit Ticket — it's tomorrow's data — and move the CER to homework or the next day.

Appendix · How this plan maps to the TEAM rubric

TEAM indicator	Where addressed
Standards & Objectives	§1 — I-CAN + sequenced sub-objectives + prior learning
Motivating Students	§3 Hook — Tennessee relevance
Presenting Content	§3 DI — deck visuals + Cornell Notes + modeling
Lesson Structure & Pacing	§3 — 47-min segmented, warm-up → closure
Activities & Materials	§4 — varied, choice, primary sources, complex text
Questioning	§5 — DOK 1–4 ladder, text-based, cite evidence
Feedback	§7 — checkpoints during guided practice
Grouping	§7 — pairs + whole-class + individual
Teacher Content Knowledge	§1/§4 — accurate, standards-aligned content
Knowledge of Students	§8 — UDL/WIDA + IEP/504
Thinking / Problem-Solving	§6 — analytical, research-based, justify a claim
PLANNING: Instructional Plans	Whole plan — sequenced, accommodations, closure
PLANNING: Student Work	§2 — CER + HIPP extended writing
PLANNING: Assessment	§2 — multiple measures + clear criteria
Environment (3 indicators)	§9 — reminders (teacher-implemented; not auto-generated)

The three PLANNING indicators (highlighted) are what a written plan is directly scored on — this template earns them structurally. The Instruction indicators are documented so the teacher walks in ready; the Environment domain is prompted, not generated.